

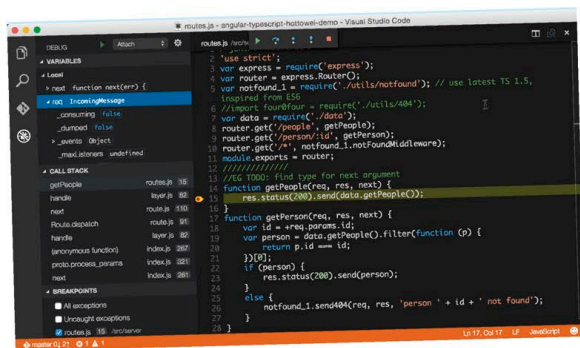
Meet the expert

Coder and author Jeff Atwood co-created Stack Overflow, a website for answering questions about coding, and Discourse, a program for communicating online.



Q: We know it is something to do with coding, but what is your actual job?

A: My job is to write commands that tell the computer what to do, and to give it commands that make it do a better job.



Code on screen

Q: What made you decide to become a software developer?

A: I've always loved computers and computer games, and once I saw that I could build my own games—not just play games other people create—I was hooked.

Q: Do you have a favorite thing that you have developed?

A: We built Stack Overflow, which is like a Wikipedia for programmers!

Q: Do you use any special equipment?

A: We use fast computers, with lots of memory. We also use multiple monitors and nice chairs.

Q: What do you love most about coding?

A: Software is easy to change to make it better, and software can also encourage people to do better things and help others.

Q: What is a usual work day for you?

A: I work from home, so I get up and head to my home office. I talk to my team via the Internet.

Q: What are the best and worst things about your job?

A: The best thing about my job is that software can touch so many people—through their smartphones, through their laptops and computers. The worst thing about my job is that I spend a lot of time talking to the computer. It can be unforgiving when you make mistakes, even tiny ones!



Jeff's computer set-up